A NEW HR HANDBOOK

At India Today HR Insights, experts shared actionable strategies on adapting to Gen Z needs and embracing Artificial Intelligence to future-proof workplaces

By Sonal Khetarpal

Post Covid, the world of work changed dramatically. Employees started expecting more from what they do, seeking growth, flexibility and work-life balance, not just a job that paid the bills. It required organisations to pivot towards strategies that could boost retention and foster loyalty.

Enter GenAI, meanwhile, and the disruption has only intensified, significantly impacting several job roles. As expectations evolve and technology transforms the workplace, how employees work, create and collaborate is also changing. The India Today HR Insights, organised at Presidency University in Bengaluru recently, focused on key trends such as creating an inclusive workforce and redefining talent acquisition strategies for the workplace of the future. The event brought together HR leaders from diverse sectors—technology, retail, IT and HR service providers—to engage in meaningful dialogues.

Subhankar Roy Chowdhury, Executive Director & Head of HR, Asia Pacific, at Lenovo, delivered the keynote 'Gearing Up for a Disruptive World', highlighting how AI is transforming organisations and workflows, reducing the need for a large workforce, and how talent must adapt to thrive in the evolving workplace.

The panel, featuring HR leaders from Adobe, IKEA, SAP and Careernet, discussed what companies need to do to attract Gen Z, retain them and unlock their potential. Research shows that they prefer flexibility, dislike hierarchy, and want to work on their own terms. Another panel, with experts from Amazon, Wipro and Adecco India, deliberated how AI is reshaping recruitment by automating tasks, improving candidate sourcing and enhancing the overall hiring experience. They also addressed what candidates need to do to land a job when AI is the interviewer. ■

KEYNOTE: *GEARING UP FOR A DISRUPTIVE WORLD*



SUBHANKAR ROY CHOWDHURY
Executive Director & Head of HR, Asia Pacific, Lenovo

TAKEAWAYS

- **Disruption has to be long-term, it has to be sustainable and impactful. It touches multiple people so much so that for a long time, it has a ripple-down effect on several other factors**
- **AI brings with it a significant opportunity, but there is going to be short-term pain**
- **The next two years, we're looking at how you embed AI into the workflows which is where the AI agents are coming in**
- **Large organisations are aggressively pursuing the AI journey and the smaller ones are following suit**
- **Companies are reporting better revenue, better income and margins but at the same time they are decreasing the workforce**
- **India's median age is 28 to 29. It is imperative that we are able to harness, optimise and make use of the resource that we have with us**

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